Nova Labs Employee Handbook

Sample document for the PDF Q&A Agent. Nova Labs is a fictional company; all policies are invented for demonstration.

1. Welcome

Nova Labs builds open-source developer tools. This handbook explains how we work, what we offer, and what we expect. Version 3.2, effective 1 January 2026.

2. Working Hours and Remote Work

Core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 16:00 Central European Time, Monday to Friday. Outside core hours, employees choose their own schedule.

Nova Labs is remote-first. Employees may work from any country where Nova Labs has a legal entity (France, Morocco, Germany and Spain) for an unlimited time, and from any other country for up to 60 days per calendar year with manager approval.

Every new employee receives a one-time home-office budget of 1,200 EUR for a desk, chair, monitor and accessories, plus a monthly internet allowance of 40 EUR.

3. Time Off

Full-time employees receive 27 days of paid vacation per year, plus public holidays of their country of residence. Up to 5 unused vacation days can be carried over to the next year and must be used before 31 March.

Sick leave: employees notify their manager before 10:00 on the first day. A medical certificate is required for absences longer than 3 consecutive working days.

Parental leave: the primary caregiver receives 20 weeks of fully paid leave and the secondary caregiver receives 10 weeks of fully paid leave, regardless of the local legal minimum.

Every employee also has 2 paid 'learning days' per quarter to attend courses, conferences or work on personal projects.

4. Expenses and Travel

Expenses must be submitted in the Expensify tool within 30 days with a receipt. Expenses above 500 EUR require manager pre-approval.

Travel: economy class for flights under 6 hours, premium economy for flights over 6 hours. Hotel limit is 180 EUR per night (250 EUR in Paris, London and New York). The daily meal allowance during travel is 60 EUR.

Learning budget: each employee has 1,500 EUR per year for books, courses and conference tickets. Unused budget does not roll over.

5. Security and Equipment

All laptops must use full-disk encryption, an automatic screen lock after 5 minutes, and the company password manager. Two-factor authentication is mandatory on all work accounts.

Lost or stolen equipment must be reported to security@novalabs.example within 24 hours.

Customer data must never be copied to personal devices or uploaded to AI tools that are not on the approved list maintained by the security team.

6. Performance and Growth

Performance reviews happen twice a year, in June and December. Salary reviews happen once a year in January. Employees can request an internal transfer after 12 months in their current role.

7. Contacts

People team: people@novalabs.example. IT help desk: it@novalabs.example. Security: security@novalabs.example.